present 2 steamships and a steam launch. It is necessary to add at present to this small nucleus a vessel of our own and chartered steamer. The Company has resolved to raise a debenture loan of 3 lacs of rupees and issued for the purpose 300 debentures of Rs. 1000 each and it has in addition increased its capital from 10 to 20 lacs divided into 80,000 shares of Rs. 25 each. If a hundred of the wealthy men of India were to take up one debenture each and four thousands of the middle class were to take each one share, we should be able to start of our business with an absolute certainty of success.

In addition to the good the Company is doing by its work to national development and its pioneer work in the past, it offers training to young men from various parts of India in navigation and shipbuilding on condition of serving for some years in the company's fleet. Is it too much to expect that the Pioneer Steam Navigation Company financed, managed and run by Indians will easily command the small amount of additional support required from our countrymen? The hope of our rival is that the company will fail to command the funds necessary for its undertakings and that, after its extinction, they will be able to recover their monopoly and recoup the losses the competition has inflicted on them. Repeated prophesies have been made of our collapse. The Company has survived them all and it only needs this assistance from our countrymen to end the competition in our favour, and disappoint forever the hopes of those who exploit our industry and commerce and seek to preserve their monopoly.

We appeal to the country at large not nearly [merely] as a profitable financial concern, but as a national undertaking whose success will be the symbol of a great patriotic victory. By our past and our future, we belong not merely to Madras but to all India and from all India we look for the support for which we make this appeal.

The Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company Ltd. of Tuticorin.

3rd August, 1909,
14 Clive Street

S.D. KRISHNAYANGAR, Secretary